November 7, 2025

VineSight Policy Guide

Detecting disinformation with transparency, integrity, and human-centered safeguards

OUR VISION

Identify emerging disinformation early
—responsibly and transparently

WHAT WE DO

AI-driven narrative intelligence detecting coordinated disinformation through behavioral pattern analysis, protecting information integrity while preserving open expression.

1. Introduction

VineSight is an AI-driven narrative intelligence startup detecting coordinated disinformation before it escalates. Founded in 2018, VineSight analyzes social platforms to identify suspicious sharing patterns to detect early signs of coordinated manipulation.

As artificial intelligence presents both unprecedented opportunities and risks in the "coming wave" of technological change (Suleyman, 2023), our approach focuses on behavioral coordination rather than content quality, addressing a core policy dilemma: **protecting information integrity without becoming arbiters of truth.**

2. Human Rights by Design & Core Values

Dignity & Non-Discrimination:
Never target based on identity; protect legitimate activism

Due Process & Remedy:
Right to appeal with independent review (BSR, 2021)

Transparency:
Document signals and thresholds; publish methodology (CRS, 2023)

Participation: Engage civil society, researchers, impacted communities

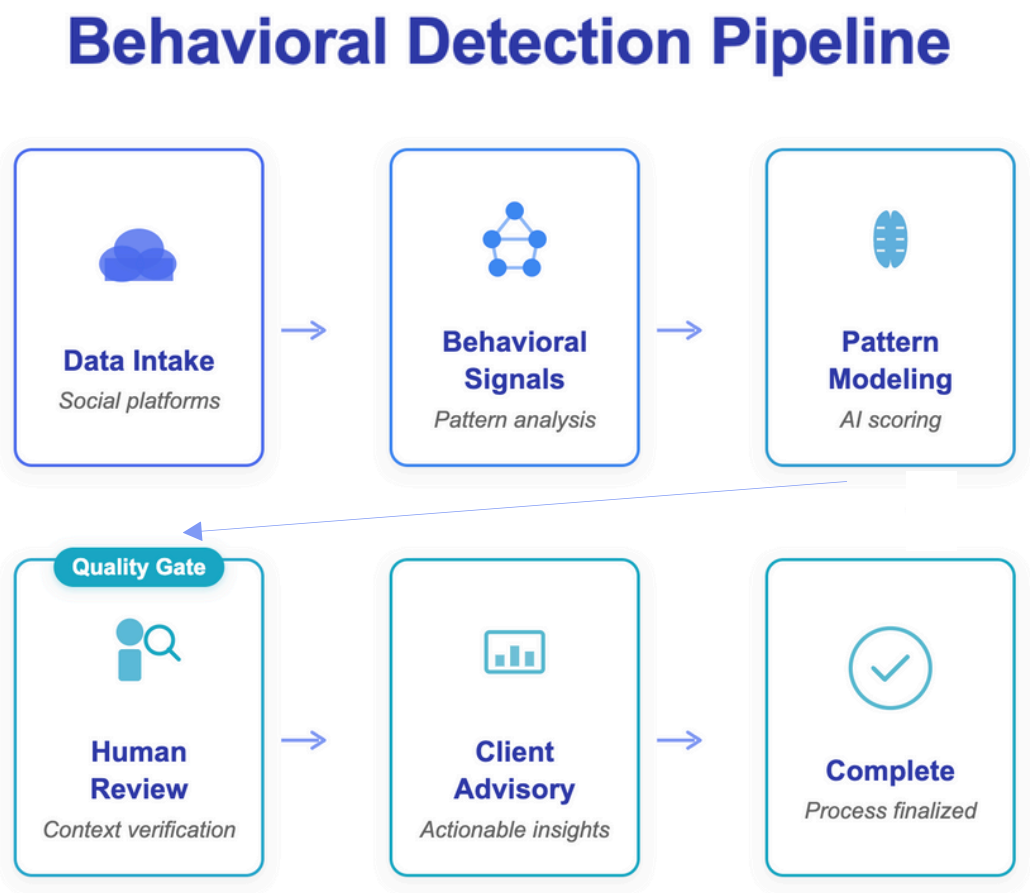
Policy Trade-off: We balance detection accuracy with rights protection through conservative thresholds, multi-gate review, and rapid appeals.

Our work impacts public trust and individual safety. We pair technical rigor with human-centered safeguards, grounded in human rights by design (Cadranel, 2024; BSR, 2021).

VALUE	PRACTICE
Integrity & Accuracy	Focus on coordination patterns, not ideology
Human-Centered Safeguards	Layered review with human-in-the-loop (CRS, 2023)
Accountability	Transparent documentation and correction statistics
Equity & Non-Discrimination	No targeting of protected characteristics
Privacy by Design	Minimal data collection, routine audits
Collaboration for Safety	Work with civil society and researchers (All Tech is Human, 2024)

3. Code of Conduct

Principles and Acceptable Use Guidelines



- **Pattern, not viewpoint:** We focus on coordination patterns such as inauthentic amplification, synchronized activity across accounts—never on ideology or speech content. This reduces viewpoint discrimination documented in content-based moderation systems (Congressional Research Service, 2023).

- **Thresholds for action:** Automated signals trigger review, not labels, until corroborated by multiple independent indicators (timing patterns, account history, cross-platform activity, network structure).

- **Context-first classification:** We document claim, context, provenance, and confidence with every finding. Lawful criticism, satire, and journalism are out of scope for manipulation labels.

- **Human-in-the-loop:** High-impact classifications (elections, health) require ethics-trained human review before client delivery. AI assists judgment; it doesn't replace it (All Tech is Human, 2024).

4. Privacy Statement

VineSight aligns with EU General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) principles and comparable frameworks including California Consumer Privacy Act (CCPA/CPRA). We process publicly available content and limited metadata to detect coordinated manipulation while minimizing collection and use of personal data.

4.1 WHAT WE COLLECT & WHY

Data: URLs, timestamps, engagement counts, network relations, account-level public signals, behavioral feature hashes

Legal Basis: Legitimate interests in safeguarding information integrity (under GDPR Article 6); client contracts; legal obligations where applicable

We rely on legitimate interests rather than consent because manipulators wouldn't consent, making it unworkable for security purposes. This requires demonstrable safeguards—our strict minimization, short retention, and appeals.

4.2 DATA PROTECTION PRINCIPLES

We follow seven GDPR principles with specific implementations:

- **Fairness & Transparency:** Clear website notices; high-level methodology documentation
- **Purpose Limitation:** Only for coordination detection, security, evaluation—never marketing or third-party sales
- **Data Minimization:** Prefer aggregates and pseudonymous identifiers; analyze that accounts posted synchronously, not what they posted
- **Accuracy:** Versioned evidence bundles; reproducible pipelines; correction via appeals
- **Storage Limitation:** Raw identifiers ⩽ 90 days; aggregated features ⩽ 18 months; public reports retained but subject to correction
- **Security:** Encryption in transit/at rest; access controls; audited actions; annual penetration testing
- **Accountability:** Privacy impact assessments for high-risk cases; quarterly internal audits; annual external assessments; processing activity documentation

5. Transparency & Accountability

We believe organizational legitimacy follows from openness about methods, limitations, and outcomes (van der Linden et al., 2017). Transparency enables external accountability and builds stakeholder trust (Suleyman, 2023). While disclosure creates competitive risks, the benefits of external scrutiny outweigh these concerns for an organization operating in the public interest.

5.1 WHAT WE PUBLISH ANNUALLY

Methodology: Behavioral signals used; model approaches; known limitations; changes from prior year

System Metrics: Precision/recall by domain and language; false-positive rate; appeal statistics; average review times

Usage Statistics: Narratives assessed; proportion escalated to human review; actions by category

Governance: Policy updates; subprocessor changes; security incidents (anonymized); audit summaries

Rationale: Disclosure creates risks—competitors could copy methods; manipulators could adapt. However, research shows transparency enhances trust and enables collective learning (Lewandowsky et al., 2020). Benefits of external scrutiny outweigh competitive risks.

Public Transparency Dashboard (Sample Metrics)

Metric	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
Precision / Recall	0.93 / 0.90	0.94 / 0.91	0.93 / 0.92	**0.94 / 0.92** ▲
False Positive Rate	1.6%	1.4%	1.5%	**1.3%** ▼
Cases with Human Review	38%	41%	39%	**42%** ▲
Appeals (upheld / modified / reversed)	21 / 6 / 3	18 / 7 / 4	24 / 5 / 4	**20 / 6 / 5** –
Median Review Time	36h	34h	35h	**33h** ▼

Quarterly performance indicators showing system precision, false positive rates, human review rates, appeals outcomes, and review times.

5.2 INDEPENDENT OVERSIGHT

- Third-party technical audits with published summary findings
- External Ethics Advisory Group comprising academic researchers, civil society representatives, and former regulators
- Quarterly stakeholder meetings with published summaries of discussions and recommendations
- Public version control system tracking all policy and methodology changes with explanations

This governance structure embeds external voices in our decision-making, addressing the documented limitation that purely internal review processes can become insular and self-serving (All Tech is Human, 2024).

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